



Young social media users fare worse in school exams - study

研究显示：过早接触社交媒体的青少年学业表现较差

难度评级：★★★★☆☆

【 Para.1 】

Children who open social media accounts at the start of **secondary** school appear to perform worse in tests than those who sign up later, with researchers suspecting that the constant checking for updates is a major **distraction** for many students.

那些在中学伊始便开通社交媒体账号的孩子，其考试成绩似乎不及较晚注册的同龄人。研究人员推测，频繁刷新查看更新是干扰许多学生注意力的重要因素。

【 Para.2 】

Pupils who opened their first social media account aged 11 to 12 scored lower in mathematics and reading tests than those who waited, with scores at age 16 differing between the groups by the **equivalent** of about six months of learning, the study found.

文章导读：

中学初开社交账号的学生成绩更差，研究排除其他因素影响。早期使用者学业落后约半年，效果等同高强度辅导成果的一半。数学与意大利语差距显著，但英语未受影响，频繁刷手机是关键预测指标。持续刷手机制造警觉状态，降低学生对家庭和学业的投入度。英法拟推禁令，澳大利亚去年已对16岁以下青少年实施。支持年龄门槛但视为应急之举，主张让平台本身更安全，另一教授称研究佐证共识，首次接触年龄影响学业轨迹。建议家长教育者支持年轻人养成健康使用习惯而非禁止。

secondary adj./'sekəndri/ 1) less important than sth else 次要的；从属的；辅助的【考研英语词汇】

Experience is what matters—age is of **secondary importance**.

重要的是经验—年龄是次要的。

happening as a result of sth else 间接引发的；继发性的；次生的

a **secondary infection** 继发性感染

connected with teaching children of 11-18 years 中等教育的；中学的

secondary teachers 中学教师

distraction n./dr'strækʃn/ a thing that takes your attention away from what you are doing or thinking about 分散注意力的事；使人分心的事

I find it hard to work at home because there are too many **distractions**.

我发觉在家里工作很难，因为使人分心的事太多。

pupil n./'pju:p(ə)/ a person who is taught by a teacher, especially a child in school, or a student who is under the close supervision of a particular tutor or expert. 学生，门生，弟子（通常指小学生、中学生，或跟随某位导师专门学习的弟子）【考研英语词汇】

The school has over 1,000 **pupils** aged between 6 and 12. 这所学校有超过1000名年龄在6岁到12岁之间的学生。

equivalent n./'kwivələnt/ a thing, amount, word, etc. that is equivalent to sth else 相等的东西；等量；对应词【考研英语词汇】

Send €20 or the **equivalent** in your own currency.

寄20欧元或等值的贵国货币。

研究发现，在11至12岁便拥有首个社交媒体账号的学生，其数学和阅读测试得分均低于那些延迟注册的同伴；到16岁时，两组间的分数差距大约相当于六个月的学业进度差异。

【 Para.3 】

The work does not prove social media is to blame, but the researchers took account of many other factors that could **skew** the results, such as the students' performance before they had social media, their family structure and parents' education.

该研究虽未直接证明社交媒体是罪魁祸首，但研究者已尽量排除其他可能影响结果的变量，如学生接触社交媒体前的学业表现、家庭结构及父母的教育等。

【 Para.4 】

"I think we now know there is a problem, and that it's a complex problem, to do with how these platforms are built," said Dr Marco Gui, the first author on the study at the University of Milano-Bicocca in Italy. "Our research shows that at least during **pre-adolescence**, these social media are problematic."

该研究第一作者、意大利米兰比可卡大学的马可·桂博士表示：“我认为我们现在已意识到问题的存在，而且这是一个复杂的问题，与这些平台的底层设计密切相关。我们的研究表明，至少在青春期前阶段，社交媒体确实存在隐患。”

【 Para.5 】

Gui and his colleagues analysed surveys on the social media habits of more than 5,000 Italian schoolchildren and their

skew v./skju:/ 1) to change or influence sth with the result that it is not accurate, fair, normal, etc. 歪曲；曲解；使不公允；影响...的准确性

to **skew the statistics** 影响统计数字的准确性

to move or lie at an angle, especially in a position that is not normal 偏离；歪斜

The ball **skewed** off at a right angle.

球呈直角偏离弹了出去。

pre-adolescence n./'pri: ædəʊ'lesəns/ The period of human development just before adolescence, typically ranging from around ages 9 to 12, during which children begin to show physical, emotional, and social changes that precede the onset of puberty. 前青春期 / 青春前期 (名词)：指紧接在青春期之前的生长发育阶段，通常涵盖 9 岁到 12 岁 左右。这一时期儿童开始在身体、情绪和社交方面显现出即将进入青春期的初步变化。

During **pre-adolescence**, friendships tend to shift from large playgroups to smaller, more exclusive cliques based on shared interests.

在青春前期，友谊模式往往从大型玩伴群体转变为基于共同兴趣的更小、更具排他性的小圈子。

standardised adj./'stændədaɪzd/ means to change them so that they all have the same features. 使标准化

The parts of an automobile are **standardized**.

汽车零件是标准化了的。

gap n./gæp/ 1) a space between two things or in the middle of sth, especially because there is a part missing 开口；豁口；缺口；裂口【考研大纲词汇】

a **gap** in a hedge 树篱的豁口

a period of time when sth stops, or between two events 间断；间隔；间隙

a **gap** in the conversation 谈话的间隙

a difference that separates people, or their opinions, situation, etc. 分歧；隔阂；差距

the **gap** between rich and poor 贫富之间的差距

a space where sth is missing 缺口；空白；漏洞

His death left an enormous **gap** in my life.

他去世给我的生活留下巨大的空白。

intensive adj./m'tensɪv/ 1) involving a lot of work or activity done in a short time 短时间内集中紧张进行的；密集的【考研大纲词汇】

an **intensive** language course 速成语言课程

extremely thorough; done with a lot of care 彻底的；十分细致的

His disappearance has been the subject of **intensive** investigation. 他的失踪一直是大力调查的重点。

aimed at producing as much food as possible using as little land or as little money as possible 集约的

intensive agriculture 集约农业

results in **standardised** maths, Italian and English exams.

桂及其同事分析了逾5000名意大利学童的社交媒体使用习惯调查数据，并将其与他们在数学、意大利语和英语标准化考试中的成绩进行关联分析。

【 Para.6 】

When tested at age 13 to 14, those who opened their first social media account at 11 or 12 scored worse than those who waited until at least 14 years old. The score **gap** for Italian remained at age 15 to 16, but widened for maths.

在13至14岁进行的测试中，11或12岁便开通社交媒体的学生，其成绩不如那些至少等到14岁才注册的同龄人。意大利语的分数差距在15至16岁时依然存在，而数学差距则进一步拉大。

【 Para.7 】

Writing in Nature Human Behaviour, the researchers say the difference in scores is roughly equivalent to the early adopters falling behind by six months of schooling. Put another way, the benefit to those who delayed social media was about half that achieved with **intensive** and costly **tutoring**.

研究团队在《自然·人类行为》期刊上指出，分数差距大致相当于早期使用者落后了约半年的学业进度。换言之，延迟接触社交媒体所带来的增益，约等于高强度、高成本辅导所能取得效果的一半。

【 Para.8 】

While a performance gap was evident for maths and Italian, there was no impact on English, which the students were

tutoring n./'tju:tərɪŋ/ The act of providing individual or small-group instruction to a student, typically outside of regular classroom hours, to supplement learning, reinforce concepts, or address specific academic difficulties.辅导 / 家教 / 个别教学 (名词)：指在常规课堂之外，以一对一或小组形式为学生提供的补充性教学活动，目的是巩固知识、强化概念或解决特定的学习困难【考研大纲词汇】

One-on-one **tutoring** allows the teacher to tailor the lesson pace to the student's individual learning needs.

一对一的辅导能让老师根据学生个人的学习需求调整教学进度。

incidental adj./'ɪnsɪ'dentl/ 1) happening in connection with sth else, but not as important as it, or not intended 附带的；次要的；非有意的

The discovery was **incidental** to their main research.

这一发现是他们主要研究中的附带收获。

happening as a natural result of sth 作为自然结果的；伴随而来的；免不了的

These risks are **incidental** to the work of a firefighter.

这些风险是担任消防员不可避免的。

speculate v./'spekjuleɪt/ 1) to form an opinion about sth without knowing all the details or facts 推测；猜测；推断【考研大纲词汇】

We all **speculated** about the reasons for her resignation.

我们大家都推测过她辞职的原因。

to buy goods, property, shares, etc., hoping to make a profit when you sell them, but with the risk of losing money 投机；做投机买卖

He likes to **speculate** on the stock market.

他喜欢炒股。

minor n./'maɪnə(r)/ 1) a person who is under the age at which you legally become an adult and are responsible for your actions 未成年人【考研大纲词汇】

It is an offence to serve alcohol to **minors**.

向未成年人提供含酒精的饮料是违法的。

a subject that you study at university in addition to your major 辅修科目；辅修课程

adj. 1) not very large, important or serious 较小的；次要的；轻微的

a **minor** road 小路

based on a scale in which the third note is a semitone/half tone higher than the second note 小调的；小音阶的

the key of C **minor** C小调

cognitive adj./'kɒgnətɪv/ connected with mental processes of understanding 认知的；感知的；认识的【考研大纲词汇】

cognitive psychology 认知心理学

learning as a foreign language, possibly because so much social media is in English, providing “**incidental** exposure and practice”, the researchers said. **One of the best predictors of the performance gap was how often children picked up their phones throughout the day and night, suggesting that constantly checking social media was at least partly to blame.**

数学和意大利语的成绩差距显著，但英语（作为外语学习）却未受影响。研究者推测，这可能是因为大量社交媒体内容以英语呈现，无形中为学生提供了“附带性的语言接触与练习”。预测成绩差距的最佳指标之一，是学生全天频繁查看手机的频率——这表明持续刷社交媒体至少是部分成因。

【 Para.9 】

Gui said: “We **speculate** that one of the mechanisms is the continuous state of alert that social media used on a smartphone exerts on **minors**’ lives. The continuous need to check messages, to see if something is happening in the online world ... This means being less present in the physical space of the family or the house. And from a **cognitive** point of view, it could mean being less engaged in something that takes time, as homework can for a student of that age.”

桂表示：“我们推测，其中的一个机制是智能手机上的社交媒体在未成年人生活中制造了一种持续警觉的状态——不断查看消息、时刻关注线上世界是否发生新动态……这意味着他们更少地待在家庭或住所的实际空间里。从认知角度而言，这也意味着他们对那些

approve v./ə'pru:v/ 1) to think that sb/sth is good, acceptable or suitable 赞成；同意【考研大纲词汇】

I told my mother I wanted to leave school but she didn't **approve**. 我告诉母亲我不想继续上学，但是母亲不同意。

OPP disapprove

to officially agree to a plan, request, etc. 批准，通过（计划、要求等）

The committee unanimously **approved** the plan.

委员会一致通过了计划。

to say that sth is good enough to be used, or is correct 认可；核准

The course is **approved** by the Department for Education.

课程已获教育部核准。

diminish v./dɪ'mɪnɪʃ/ 1) to become or to make sth become smaller, weaker, etc. 减少；（使）减弱，缩减；降低【考研大纲词汇】

SYN decrease

His influence has **diminished** with time.

随着时间的推移，他的影响已不如从前了。

to make sb/sth seem less important than they really are 贬低；贬损；轻视

I don't wish to **diminish** the importance of their contribution. 我并不要贬低他们所作贡献的重要性。

psychiatry n./saɪ'kaɪətri/ the study and treatment of mental illness 精神病学；精神病治疗【考研大纲词汇】

Psychology and **psychiatry** shouldn't be enemies.

心理学和精神病学不应该是敌人。

➤ 今日句子分析

主句

One of the best predictors of the performance gap **was**

主语

系动词

疑问副词引导的名词性从句

how often children picked up their phones throughout the

主语

谓语

宾语

状语

宾语从句

day and night, suggesting that **constantly checking social**

现在分词短语

主语

media was at least partly to blame.

系动词

表语

需要持续投入时间的任务（如同龄学生的课后作业）

投入度降低。”

【 Para.10 】

The study comes as the UK is poised to introduce a social media ban for under-16s, following Australia, which brought in its own ban last year. France has also **approved** a bill restricting access to under-15s.

这项研究发布之际，英国正计划效仿澳大利亚（去年已实施相关禁令），对16岁以下青少年推行社交媒体禁令。法国也已通过法案，限制15岁以下人群访问社交平台。

【 Para.11 】

While Gui favours an age limit on social media, he said a ban was an “emergency policy” and that work was needed to make the platforms themselves safer and less addictive. “For pre-adolescents we have to work on **diminishing** the social relevance of these environments,” he said.

桂虽支持对社交媒体设置年龄门槛，但他认为禁令仅属“应急之策”，更根本的工作在于让平台本身变得更安全、减少其成瘾性。“对于青春期前儿童，我们必须致力于降低这些环境的社会吸引力，”他说。

【 Para.12 】

Dennis Ougrin, a professor of child and adolescent **psychiatry** at Queen Mary University of London, said the work added to growing evidence that the age at which young people first engage with social media may affect their educational development.

翻译注意事项：

One of + 复数名词 的主谓一致：One of the best predictors 作主语，谓语用单数 was，而非 were。中文无此语法限制，但需准确译为“最佳预测指标之一”。

how often 从句的转换：用疑问词引导名词性从句作表语，中文习惯说“.....的频率是.....”。不宜直译为“孩子们多久拿一次手机”，应译为“.....的频率”或“.....的次数多少”，更符合中文书面语。

be to blame 的主动表被动：这是一个固定结构，意为“应受责备/是原因”，而非“去责备别人”。必须译为“是.....的原因”或“应归咎于”，不能译为“去责备”。例如：...was at least partly to blame → “至少是部分原因”。

写作积累

1.(Para.9) Gui said: “We speculate that one of the mechanisms is the continuous state of alert that social media used on a smartphone exerts on minors’ lives.

exert on :意为“对.....施加（影响/压力）”，具体指社交媒体通过手机在未成年人生活中施加/制造了一种“持续警觉状态”。这个词选得非常精准，因为它不是中性“带来”（bring），也不是弱化“引起”（cause），而是强调一种持续、主动、有压力的作用力——像一种外力不断按压着未成年人的注意力。

本来的含义：exert 源于拉丁语 exserere（“向外伸出”），本义为“使出、发挥（力量/能力）”，常搭配 force / influence / pressure / control 等抽象名词，意为主动施加某种作用力。

与介词 on / upon 连用，表示作用的对象。

2.(Para.10) The study comes as the UK is poised to introduce a social media ban for under-16s, following Australia, which brought in its own ban last year. France has also approved a bill restricting access to under-15s.

be poised to : 意为“准备就绪、即将”，特指英国已经处于“即将出台”社交媒体禁令的状态——政策已在规划中，随时可能正式实施。它传达出一种“箭在弦上”的紧迫感和确定性。

poised 本身是形容词，来自动词 poise（使平衡、使悬停），本义为“平衡的、平稳的、优雅镇定的”（如 poised posture 优雅的姿态）。

当与 to 连用（poised to do something）时，引申为“做好了充分准备、处于随时可行动的状态”。这一用法比喻一个人或实体像芭蕾舞者一样“踮起脚尖、蓄势待发”，只差一个信号就能行动。

同义表达：

be on the verge of 濒临、即将（强调“差一点就”）

be set to 准备、将要（常用新闻语境，如 set to rise）

反义表达：

hold back from 退缩、迟疑不前

be hesitant to 犹豫不决、不情愿

伦敦玛丽女王大学儿童与青少年精神病学教授丹尼斯·奥格林表示，该研究进一步佐证了日益增多的共识——年轻人初次接触社交媒体的年龄，确有可能影响其学业发展轨迹。

【 Para.13 】

“The message for parents, educators and

policymakers is not necessarily to ban social media, but to support young people in developing healthy habits when interacting with social media,” he said.

“家长、教育者和决策者不应一味想着禁止社交媒体，而应支持年轻人在与之互动时养成健康的使用习惯，”他说。